Pakistan could handle the security of its nukes but not the perception about the vulnerability of its nuclear arsenal. Media was the arena, which propelled this perception to the level of paranoia. In 2009, when the Swati Taliban fraudulently forged their way into Buner, in Swat, the BBC gave breaking news that Islamabad was only 80 miles away, giving an impression that terrorists could comfortably cruise towards the capital of Pakistan and capture it. It was an entirely unrealistic presentation.

In fact, Taliban did not have the capacity and even a plan to fight with the army to make advancement towards Islamabad.

It is very clear that the insurgents and terrorists cannot defeat the army to take over Pakistan in a regular war. They are fighting an asymmetrical war. Their objective is to strike at the roots of the country so that it might crumble due to a dilapidated economy, immense social and psychological distress, international isolation and threat to strategic assets. It was a disastrous situation especially when the state response was weak and religious extremism and sectarianism were on the rise. Since 2013, Pakistan has been addressing these aspects very seriously and the civil-military leadership was in agreement to bring a turnaround in the situation. Nuclear safeguards were as stringent and effective as possible; therefore, apprehensions of nuclear weapons falling in the hands of terrorists were highly misplaced.